

THE BUZZ

BCI SURVEY

THE MOOD TURNS SOMBRE

The *BT-C* Fore Business Confidence Survey reveals that business confidence dipped in Q3 amidst slower economic growth

BY SURABHI

► **THE YEAR 2024** ended on a sombre note for India Inc. amidst a sharper-than-anticipated slowdown in economic growth in the second quarter of the fiscal, stubbornly high inflation, and external uncertainties, especially a lack of clarity on US President-Elect Donald Trump's tariff policies.

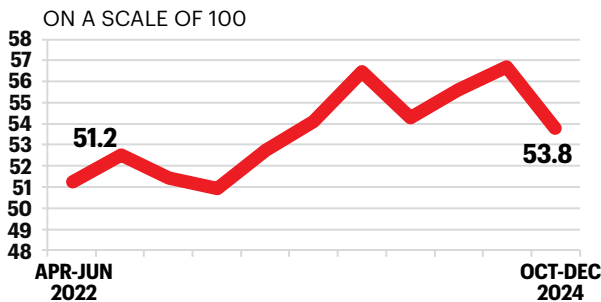
This was reflected in the *BT-C* Fore Business Confidence Survey of 500 chief executive officers (CEOs) and chief financial officers (CFOs) for the October to December 2024 quarter, which revealed that the business confidence index (BCI) dipped to 53.8 from a nine-year high of 56.7 in the previous quarter.

The BCI for the October-December 2024 quarter was the lowest in this calendar year and was in fact the weakest since the April-June 2023 quarter when the reading came in at 52.7.

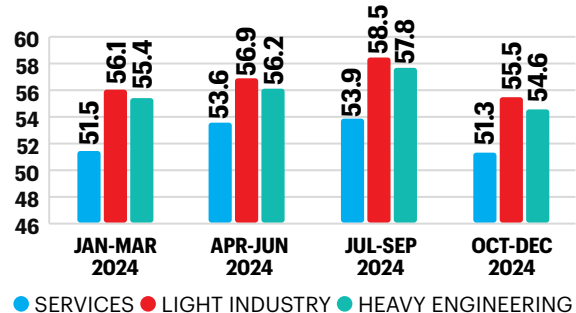
Business confidence dipped across sectors and sizes of companies in the October-December 2024 quarter as against the previous quarter. Amongst sectors,

A CAUTIOUS NOTE

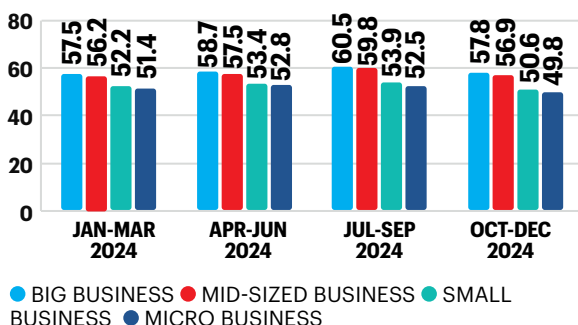
Business confidence: Sentiment drops



Subdued mood across sectors



Sentiment lower across business sizes but small and micro feel more pain



Looking forward, Q4 mood stays cautious

